AI Workshop: Workflow Automation

Recognize, map and automate processes

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ai-workflow.rocketflow.nl

Agenda overview

Time	Block	Style
0:00 - 0:30	1. What are processes & when to automate?	Discussion
0:30 - 1:00	2. Map a process in Excalidraw	Hands-on
1:00 - 1:15	Break	
1:15 - 1:45	3. Introduction to Make.com	Demo
1:45 - 2:45	4. Build the order intake automation	Hands-on
2:45 - 3:00	Break	
3:00 - 3:20	5. A look at n8n	Demo
3:20 - 3:45	6. Identify your own automation opportunity	Exercise
3:45 - 4:00	7. Wrap-up, resources & Q&A	Discussion

Common thread: think → draw → see → build → next steps

BLOCK 1

What are processes & when to automate?

0:00 - 0:30

Interactive discussion

Block 1

Interactive opener

“Name something you did today that goes the same way every day.”

Think of: checking email, entering orders, calling a supplier, verifying packing slips...

Block 1

The automation checklist

Is this process automatable? Score on 4 criteria:

1. Repetitive

Does it happen regularly? Daily, weekly, or with every order?

2. Rule-based

Can you describe the steps as clear rules or decisions?

3. Digital

Does it involve digital tools, data, or systems?

4. Time-consuming

Does it take noticeable time you could spend better?

Score 3 or 4? Strong automation candidate!

Block 1

Group scoring exercise

- Take **3-4 examples** from the opener
- Score each example together using the **4 criteria**
- Discuss as a group: do we agree?
- Goal: learn to think in terms of **“is this automatable?”**

Tip: Disagreement is good! It’s about the way of thinking, not the “right” answer.

BLOCK 2

Map a process in Excalidraw

0:30 - 1:00

Hands-on exercise

Block 2

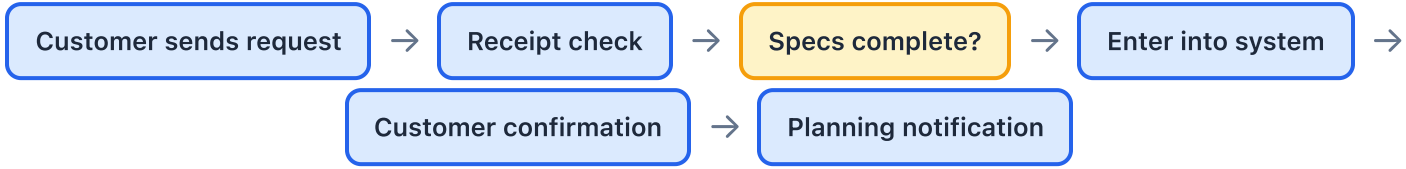
Excalidraw: quick intro

- Open **excalidraw.com** via the landing page
- You only need 3 things: **rectangles, arrows, text**
- It's a **thinking tool**, not a design tool
- Ugly is fine! It's about the **process**, not the looks

Key message: "If you can draw it, you can automate it."

Block 2

Example: order intake process



- Use **decision diamonds** for yes/no splits
- Keep it to **5-7 steps** maximum
- Not complete? No-path: “Follow up with customer”

Block 2

Pair exercise (15 min)

- Form **pairs of 2**
- Choose a process from the earlier brainstorm
- Draw it in Excalidraw - **maximum 8 steps**

Orange = manual step

Green = can be automated

Last 3 minutes: 2-3 pairs briefly share their screen

Break

15 minutes - 1:00 - 1:15

BLOCK 3

Introduction to Make.com

1:15 - 1:45

Live demo

Block 3

Core concepts

From Excalidraw drawing to Make.com scenario:

Make.com term	What it is	Excalidraw equivalent
Scenario	Your automation	The whole picture
Module	A step	A rectangle
Connection	Link to a tool	The outgoing arrow
Trigger	What kicks it off	The first block

Recognize it? Your Excalidraw drawing IS already a Make.com scenario!

Block 3

Live interface tour

- Create a **free Make.com account** (link on the landing page)
- Walk through together: **creating a scenario**
- Search and connect **modules**
- The **“Run once”** button: instant feedback, no deploy needed

Advantage: Visual, drag-and-drop, see results immediately - no code required!

Block 3

Demo: order intake automation

Receive webhook data → AI analyses order → Confirmation email customer → Notification production

- Watch live data flow through the modules
- From request to AI-generated email in **seconds**

Next step: “You’re going to build this yourselves now.”

Block 3

Form fields

The webhook/form contains these fields:

Field	Type	Description
Company name	Text	Name of the company
Contact person	Text	Name of the requester
Email	Email	For the confirmation
Product description	Text	What is being ordered
Quantity	Number	How many units
Desired delivery date	Date	When needed

BLOCK 4

Build the order intake automation

1:45 - 2:45

Guided hands-on

Block 4

Checklist: 5 steps

Open the checklist on the landing page and check off each step:

- [ ] **Step 1:** Set up webhook trigger (5 min)
- [ ] **Step 2:** Add AI module (5 min)
- [ ] **Step 3:** Set up confirmation email (10 min)
- [ ] **Step 4:** Production notification (5 min)
- [ ] **Step 5:** Test! (10 min)

Check: Make.com open and logged in? Then let's get started!

Block 4 Stretch goal & troubleshooting

Done early? Stretch goal:

- Add a **filter** to your scenario
- For example: only notify when **Quantity > 100**
- Discover the “Filter” option between two modules

Troubleshooting tips:

- **Connection failed?** Check your webhook URL
- **No data?** Make sure the form has been filled in at least once
- **Stuck?** Ask your neighbour or the trainer

Peer help: Pair fast finishers with slower participants

Break

15 minutes - 2:45 - 3:00

BLOCK 5

A look at n8n

3:00 - 3:20

Demo

Block 5

What is n8n?

- **Open source** and self-hostable - your data stays with you
- Free on your own server, or hosted via **n8n.cloud**
- Same concept as Make.com: visual flows with modules and connections
- **Code nodes:** write JavaScript/Python when needed
- **Self-hosted** = no data leaves your building (relevant for IP)
- **Community nodes** for niche integrations

Block 5

The same scenario in n8n

The same order intake flow, different tool:

Form Trigger → OpenAI Chat → Send Email confirmation → Send Email notification

- More technical interface, but **more flexibility**
- Compare: drag-and-drop vs. node configuration

Block 5

When to use what?

	Make.com	n8n
Ideal for	Quick wins, simple flows	Complex logic, privacy requirements
User	Non-technical	Technical team available
Data	SaaS (cloud)	Self-hosted option
Cost	Subscription per operation	Free (self-hosted) or paid cloud

No hands-on - awareness only. **“If you want more later, this is the next step.”**

BLOCK 6

Identify your own automation opportunity

3:20 - 3:45

Group exercise

Block 6

Individual brainstorm (5 min)

Go back to the processes from Block 1 and pick one that scored high.

- **What triggers it?** When does this process start?
- **What are the steps?** Describe it from start to finish
- **Which tools are involved?** Email, spreadsheet, system?

Draw it in Excalidraw (10 min) - maximum 8 steps, colour coding: orange = manual, green = automatable

Block 6 Pair sharing & feedback (10 min)

Share your drawing with a partner. The partner asks two questions:

Question 1: “Is there a step you can **remove**?”
→ Simplify

Question 2: “Which **module in Make.com** would you use here?”
→ Connect to tooling

2-3 volunteers share their idea with the whole group

BLOCK 7

Wrap-up, resources & Q&A

3:45 - 4:00

Discussion

Block 7

Recap: what did we achieve?

Think → Draw → See → Build → Own idea

Everyone built a **working automation** today!

> **“Automation is not an IT project. It starts with a process and a drawing.”**

Block 7

Resources & next steps

- **Make.com Academy** - Free courses and tutorials
- **n8n Documentation & Community** - Docs, forum, templates
- **Excalidraw** - Bookmark for process diagrams
- **Landing page** - All links and reference material

2-week challenge: Automate something at work within 2 weeks and share the result!

Questions?

Which processes did you identify today that you'd like help with?

Thank you!

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Follow-up questions?

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